



CODE DETECTIVE

RULE BOOK

REGISTRATION FEES : ₹ 149

TEAM SIZE : 3 MEMBERS per team

PRIZE POOL : ₹ 2250

FOR DETAILS CONTACT:

MALINI R: +91 73396 86617

KARTHICK: +91 83445 60086

EVENT DESCRIPTION

Crack the Code. Find the Bug.

Put your coding, debugging and analytical skills to the test in Code Detective, where participants must investigate code, trace errors and uncover hidden bugs. Examine the clues, analyze the logic and identify what went wrong to arrive at the correct solution. Every line is a clue, and every bug is a mystery waiting to be solved.

EVENT STRUCTURE

- The event is conducted entirely through the official event website.
- The event follows a 2 round format.
- Maximum total event duration: 2 hours.

TEAM COMPOSITION

- Each team must consist of 3 members.
- The same team members must participate throughout the event — no substitutions once the event begins.
- No change of team members is permitted between Round 1 and Round 2.

LOGIN PROCEDURE

- One member per team logs in to the website using the team's assigned ID.
- All teams must log in before the event officially starts.
- Once every team has logged in, the coordinators will make the announcement to begin Round 1.

ROUND 1

Round 1 is a sequential relay completed by all 3 members of the team, one after another. The code automatically passes from one member's stage to the next through the website — no manual handover is required.

Round Duration: 30 minutes total

Part	Member In Charge	Task	Time
1	Member 1	Understand the code & write test cases	10 min
2	Member 2	Fix errors only (no optimization)	10 min
3	Member 3	Optimize the code exactly as handed over	10 min

Member 1 (Understand & Write Test Cases)

- The code is shown in view-only mode — Member 1 cannot make any edits to it.
- A separate test case panel is provided and is editable.
- Member 1 must study the given (buggy, unoptimized) code, understand its intended behavior, and write relevant test cases in the panel.

Member 2 (Fix Errors)

- The code becomes editable for Member 2.
- Member 2 must fix errors/bugs only — optimization is not part of this stage.
- Whatever state the code is in when the timer ends, it is locked automatically and passed on to Member 3 as-is.

Member 3 (Optimize)

- The code remains editable.
- Member 3 must optimize the code exactly as received from Member 2.
- If bugs remain unresolved from Part 2, Member 3 is not permitted to fix them — the task is optimization only, on the code as handed over.

General Rules — Round 1

- Only the members assigned to a part may write or edit code during that part; other members may not assist.
- Once a part's timer ends, the code locks immediately and moves to the next part automatically. Any technical issue during a round must be reported to the coordinators immediately.
- Use of external help, pre-written solutions, or unauthorized assistance leads to disqualification.

SHORTLISTING

BREAK DURATION: 15 MINUTES

- Immediately after Round 1 ends, submitted code is evaluated against the hidden test cases prepared by the organizers.
- Scores are calculated based on the Round 1 judging criteria (see Judging Criteria section).
- The top 10 teams will be shortlisted to advance to Round 2.
- The same team members who participated in Round 1 must participate in Round 2 — no changes.
- Results will be announced before Round 2 begins.

ROUND 2

ROUND DURATION: 50–60 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

- Teams are given only a problem statement — no starter code is provided.
- The entire team works together as a single unit — there are no individual parts or per-member timers in this round.

TASK

- Understand the problem statement.
- Write appropriate test cases to validate the solution.
- Code a working solution from scratch.
- Optimize the solution for time and space efficiency.
- All of the above must be completed within the single allotted time block.

GENERAL RULES — ROUND 2

- No starter code or hints are provided beyond the problem statement.
- Marks will be deducted for runtime errors, incorrect output, or missing optimization (see Judging Criteria).
- Any technical issue must be reported to the coordinators immediately.
- Use of external help, pre-written solutions, or unauthorized assistance leads to disqualification.

JUDGING CRITERIA

The criteria below is a suggested scoring structure aligned to the round format above. Organizers may adjust the point distribution before the event, but it is recommended that the relative weighting (correctness carrying the most weight, followed by optimization) stays consistent for fairness.

ROUND 1 — 40 MARKS

Criteria	Marks
Test case quality — relevance & coverage of Member 1's test cases	10
Bug-fix accuracy — how many injected bugs Member 2 resolved	10
Optimization achieved by Member 3 on the handed-over code	10
Correctness — code passes hidden test cases (after Member 2 & 3's work)	10
Total	40

ROUND 2 — 60 MARKS

Criteria	Marks
Correctness — solution runs and produces expected output	20
Optimization — time & space complexity improvement	20
Test case coverage — quality and range of test cases written	10
Code clarity / structure	10
Total	60

GRAND TOTAL: 100 MARKS

- Final ranking is based on the combined score of Round 1 and Round 2.
- The decision of the judges and organizers will be final and binding.

TIE-BREAKER

- In case of a tie in scores, the team that achieves correctness with fewer hidden test case failures will be given preference.
- If still tied, the team that completed Round 1 in the shorter time will be ranked higher.